

user if device driver for any particular device is not available. It also allows user to submit the details of such device to the OpenSolaris Device Driver support group.

Popular software like Firefox, Thunderbird mail client and the OpenOffice productivity suite are available on the OpenSolaris platform. Funky 3D desktop effects are also possible through the Compiz Visual Effects which comes preloaded with OpenSolaris.

For Developers: The real fun of OpenSolaris is when you use it for development purposes. It provides a very unique set of tools which allow programmers to write better and more optimized programs and debug them easily. It also makes developing and deploying applications easy. Some of the cool features which would appeal developers are as follows.

DTrace: A unique feature of OpenSolaris, DTrace allows you to enable probes on a running application and get to know its inner workings and functioning. There are more than 60,000 probes which can be used to profile an application and new ones get added regularly. We will cover DTrace in detail later in the book. You can also refer to the DTrace Quick Start Guide which is available on the Digit DVD.

Service Management Facility (SMF): SMF is a very easy way of managing various services which run in the background to perform particular tasks. You can enable or disable any service with simple commands and easily deploy your own services. You can learn more on SMF in the Quick Start Guide available at <http://www.sun.com/bigadmin/content/selfheal/smf-quickstart.jsp>.

Network Virtualisation with Crossbow: You might have heard about creating virtual machines to run operating systems, but OpenSolaris has a unique feature called crossbow, which allows to virtualise the network. You can create multiple virtual Network Interface Cards (NIC), with their own IP and MAC addresses, based on a single NIC of your laptop or desktop and convert your laptop into a server like machine! You can learn more about Crossbow on <http://hub.opensolaris.org/bin/view/Project+crossbow/>.

ZFS File system: The ZFS file system is a revolutionary new file system that fundamentally changes the way file systems are administered, with features and benefits not found in any other file system available today. ZFS has been designed to be robust, scalable, and simple to administer. It is currently said to be the best file system in the world.

Note

There are many interesting things that can be done with Crossbow. Checkout our special section on Crossbow on <http://www.thinkdigit.com/opensolaris>.